

4th

The 4th Sheet

Your accountant gives you three sheets. I give you the fourth.

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Sample Advisory Pty Ltd

A Brisbane finance and operations consultancy: projects billed on milestones, monthly retainers and training. 6 consultants, 3 management and admin staff.

How final is this data?

September 2026

Locked

September 2026 is locked (closed 2 Oct 2026). These numbers won't change.

August 2026

Locked

August 2026 is locked (closed 2 Sep 2026). These numbers won't change.

October 2026

Incomplete

October 2026 is still in progress: figures to 6 Oct only.

The fourth sheet: September 2026 vs August 2026

Consultant utilisation, September

74.0%

▲ from 71.1% in Aug

Revenue per billable hour

\$178

▲ from \$177 in Aug

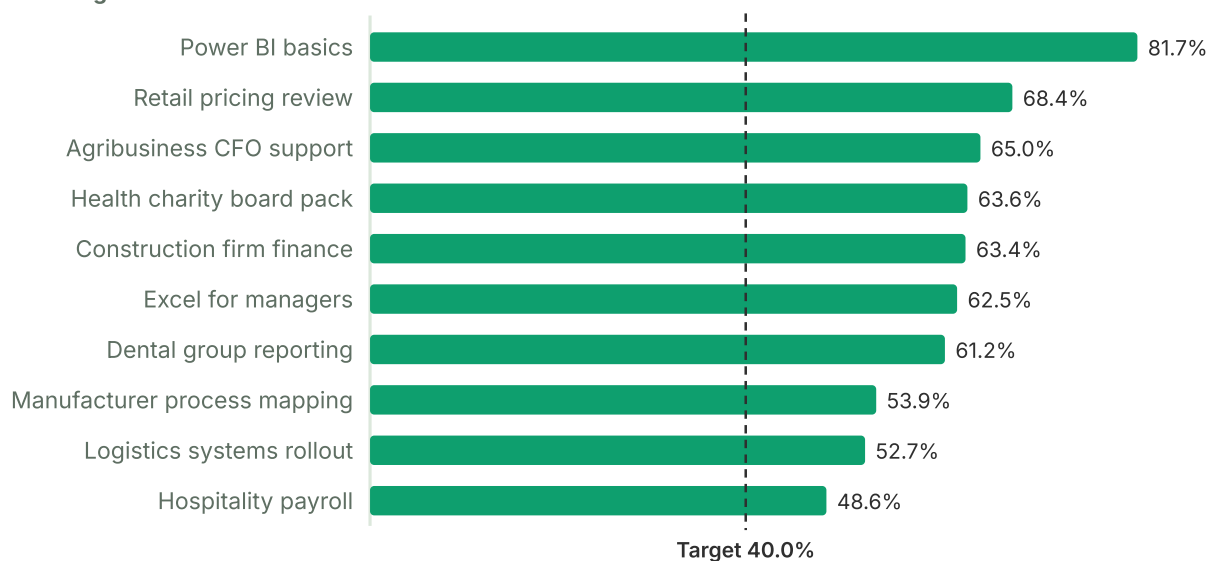
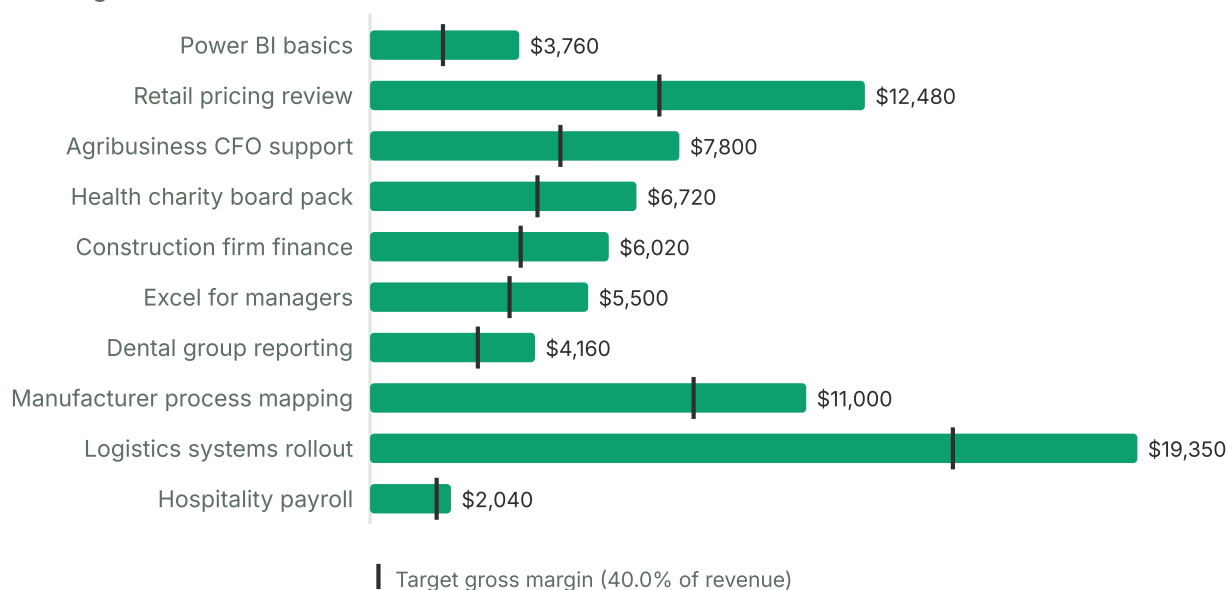
Unbilled work + unpaid invoices

\$216,090

▲ from \$149,190 in Aug

Gross margin on each client engagement, September 2026 work only

September's revenue less contractors and consultant time at \$60/hour. Before overheads: not profit. Not the whole engagement to date. One 40.0% target for every engagement for now.

Gross margin %**Gross margin \$**

How each number is worked out

Consultant utilisation

Billable hours ÷ hours available

	Sep 2026	Aug 2026
Billable hours (timesheets)	742.0 h	648.0 h
Consultants	6	6
Working days	22	20
Hours per day	7.6 h	7.6 h
Hours available	1,003.2 h	912.0 h
Utilisation	74.0%	71.1%

Revenue per billable hour

Revenue ÷ billable hours

	Sep 2026	Aug 2026
Revenue	\$131,850	\$114,640
Billable hours	742.0 h	648.0 h
Revenue per hour	\$178	\$177

Retainers and training are fixed fees, so fewer hours on them raises the hourly figure.

Cash tied up in work

Work in progress + unpaid invoices at month end

	Sep 2026	Aug 2026
Work in progress (project time not yet billed)	\$99,290	\$77,900
Unpaid client invoices	\$116,800	\$71,290
Total tied up	\$216,090	\$149,190

Milestone billing on the logistics and manufacturer projects landed at the end of September, so it moved from unbilled to unpaid.

Client engagements, September 2026

Engagement	Type	Hours	Revenue	Billed	Contractors	Gross margin	Gross margin %
Agribusiness CFO support	Retainer	70	12,000	12,000	-	7,800	65.0
Construction firm finance	Retainer	58	9,500	9,500	-	6,020	63.4
Dental group reporting	Retainer	44	6,800	6,800	-	4,160	61.2
Excel for managers	Training	30	8,800	8,800	1,500	5,500	62.5
Health charity board pack	Project	64	10,560	10,560	-	6,720	63.6
Hospitality payroll	Retainer	36	4,200	4,200	-	2,040	48.6
Logistics systems rollout	Project	210	36,750	30,000	4,800	19,350	52.7
Manufacturer process mapping	Project	120	20,400	24,000	2,200	11,000	53.9
Power BI basics	Training	14	4,600	4,600	-	3,760	81.7
Retail pricing review	Project	96	18,240	-	-	12,480	68.4

Profit and loss, September 2026

Sep 2026: locked · Aug 2026: locked

\$	Sep 2026	Aug 2026	Change
Revenue			
Projects (hours worked)	85,950	75,740	10,210
Retainers	32,500	32,500	-
Training	13,400	6,400	7,000
Total revenue	131,850	114,640	17,210
Cost of sales			
Consultant salaries (incl. on-costs)	(46,500)	(46,500)	-
Contractors	(8,500)	(6,900)	(1,600)
Total cost of sales	(55,000)	(53,400)	(1,600)
Gross profit	76,850	61,240	15,610
Operating expenses			
Management and admin wages	(24,000)	(24,000)	-
Marketing and business development	(5,800)	(6,500)	700
Rent and occupancy	(8,000)	(8,000)	-
IT and software	(4,500)	(4,500)	-
Professional indemnity insurance	(2,500)	(2,500)	-
Travel	(1,800)	(2,600)	800
Other overheads	(3,300)	(3,300)	-
Total operating expenses	(49,900)	(51,400)	1,500
EBITDA	26,950	9,840	17,110
Depreciation	(2,000)	(2,000)	-
Interest	(240)	(250)	10
Profit before tax	24,710	7,590	17,120
Income tax provision (25%)	(6,178)	(1,898)	(4,280)
Net profit after tax	18,532	5,692	12,840

Balance sheet at 30 September 2026

Sep 2026: locked · Aug 2026: locked

\$	Sep 2026	Aug 2026	Change
Current assets			
Cash at bank	149,260	192,150	(42,890)
Trade debtors (unpaid invoices)	116,800	71,290	45,510
Work in progress (unbilled project time)	99,290	77,900	21,390
Prepayments	15,000	15,000	-
Total current assets	380,350	356,340	24,010
Office equipment	60,200	59,000	1,200
Total assets	440,550	415,340	25,210
Current liabilities			
Trade creditors (bills due next month)	8,500	6,900	1,600
Employee leave provisions	122,300	121,700	600
Income tax payable	56,576	50,398	6,178
Total current liabilities	187,376	178,998	8,378
Equipment finance	14,600	16,300	(1,700)
Total liabilities	201,976	195,298	6,678
Net assets	238,574	220,042	18,532
Equity			
Share capital	20,000	20,000	-
Retained earnings	218,574	200,042	18,532
Total equity	238,574	220,042	18,532

Cash flow, September 2026

Sep 2026: locked · Aug 2026: locked

\$	Sep 2026	Aug 2026	Change
Operating activities			
Receipts from customers (invoices paid)	64,950	137,200	(72,250)
Payments to contractors and suppliers	(32,800)	(31,300)	(1,500)
Payments to employees	(69,900)	(69,800)	(100)
Interest paid	(240)	(250)	10
Income tax paid	-	-	-
Net cash from operating activities	(37,990)	35,850	(73,840)
Investing activities			
Purchase of equipment	(3,200)	-	(3,200)
Net cash from investing activities	(3,200)	-	(3,200)
Financing activities			
Equipment finance repaid	(1,700)	(1,700)	-
Net cash from financing activities	(1,700)	(1,700)	-
Net change in cash	(42,890)	34,150	(77,040)
Cash at start of month	192,150	158,000	34,150
Cash at end of month	149,260	192,150	(42,890)

Assumptions

The business

What it is	A Brisbane finance and operations consultancy: projects billed on milestones, monthly retainers and training. 6 consultants, 3 management and admin staff.
Reporting month	September 2026, compared with August 2026
Financial year	FY2027: 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027

Engagements (September)

Projects	hours worked at each project's rate; billed on milestones (unbilled time = work in progress)
Retainers	fixed monthly fee, billed monthly
Training	fixed fee, billed on delivery
Engagements in September	10 (every one is in the Excel download and CSV)

Costs

Consultants	6 on salary: \$46,500 a month incl. on-costs
Engagement costing rate	\$60/hour for consultant time
Working days	20 in August (Ekka show holiday), 22 in September; 7.6 hours a day
Income tax	25% of profit, provided monthly

Cash and balance sheet

Client payments	each invoice is paid on its own date; unpaid invoices at month end = debtors
Contractors	paid the following month
GST	excluded throughout, for simplicity

Checks (all passed)

- ✓ Every subtotal and total adds up
- ✓ Balance sheet balances: assets = liabilities + equity
- ✓ Cash flow ends at the cash in the bank
- ✓ Profit ties to the movement in retained earnings
- ✓ Every engagement's revenue adds up to the P&L
- ✓ Work in progress equals unbilled project time; debtors equal unpaid invoices

Generated 2026-10-06 by a driver-based model: every figure is calculated from the assumptions above. Sample data only, not financial advice.